LobbyView Data Export

Citation

Use of LobbyView data for academic purposes (presentations, working and conference papers, theses and dissertations, journal articles, software packages) requires that you cite the following paper:

Kim, In Song (2018). "LobbyView: Firm-level Lobbying & Congressional Bills Database." Working paper available from http://web.mit.edu/insong/www/pdf/lobbyview.pdf

Issues Data Export

This CSV export contains a complete copy of all issues lobbied in our database. Issues are susbtantive mappings required by the Lobbying Disclosure Act to be attached to all lobby filings.

The below table specifies the columns provided in this CSV export. The fourth column, "Linked Datasets", describes how a column can be used to link this data to external data, including our other CSV files.

Issue Level Variables

Column Name	Description	Data Type	Linked Datasets
`report_uuid`	Unique identifier for each lobbying filing (report), officially provided by the U.S. Senate LDA Office. Can be used to link to any other metadata about the report and through the report to other data about the client, registrant, or lobbyist.	TEXT	Report Level Data, Issue Text Data
`general_issue_code`	3-character code used to categorize the issue area covered by the lobbying activity. See below for more information.	TEXT	–
`issue_ordinal_position`	Ordinal number distinguishing the order the issue appeared in the original report (sequential, starting from 1). A row in this dataset is a single report-issue, but reports can contain many issues.	INT	–
`government_entity_ids`	An array of integer codes representing government entities that were lobbied through the activity detailed in the report. See below for more information on the entity ID mapping. See below for information on how to deal with ARRAY data in the **R** programming language.	ARRAY	–

Issue Codes

Here we replicate the official Lobbying Disclosure Act list of issue codes, originally available from the U.S. Congress

Issue Code	Issue Name	Issue Code	Issue Name
ACC	Accounting	*HOM*	Homeland Security
ADV	Advertising	*HOU*	Housing
AER	Aerospace	*IMM*	Immigration
AGR	Agriculture	*IND*	Indian / Native American Affairs
ALC	Alcohol & Drug Abuse	*INS*	Insurance

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Issue Code	Issue Name	Issue Code	Issue Name
ANI	Animals	*LBR*	Labor Issues / Antitrust / Workplace
APP	Apparel / Clothing Industry / Textiles	*INT*	Intelligence and Surveillance
ART	Arts / Entertainment	*LAW*	Law Enforcement / Crime / Criminal Justice
AUT	Automotive Industry	*MAN*	Manufacturing
AVI	Aviation / Aircraft / Airlines	*MAR*	Marine / Maritime / Boating / Fisheries
BAN	Banking	*MED*	Medical / Disease Research / Clinical Labs
BNK	Bankruptcy	*MIA*	Media (Information / Publishing)
BEV	Beverage Industry	*MMM*	Medicare / Medicaid
BUD	Budget / Appropriations	*MON*	Minting / Money / Gold Standard
CAW	Clean Air & Water (Quality)	*NAT*	Natural Resources
CDT	Commodities (Big Ticket)	*PHA*	Pharmacy
CHM	Chemicals / Chemical Industry	*POS*	Postal
CIV	Civil Rights / Civil Liberties	*RRR*	Railroads
COM	Communications / Broadcasting / Radio / TV	*RES*	Real Estate / Land Use / Conservation
CPI	Computer Industry	*REL*	Religion
CSP	Consumer Issues / Safety / Protection	*RET*	Retirement
CON	Constitution	*ROD*	Roads / Highway
CPT	Copyright / Patent / Trademark	*SCI*	Science / Technology
DEF	Defense	*SMB*	Small Business
DOC	District of Columbia	*SPO*	Sports / Athletics
DIS	Disaster Planning / Emergencies	*TAR*	Miscellaneous Tariff Bills
ECN	Economics / Economic Development	*TAX*	Taxation / Internal Revenue Code
EDU	Education	*TEC*	Telecommunications
ENG	Energy / Nuclear	*TOB*	Tobacco
ENV	Environmental / Superfund	*TOR*	Torts
FAM	Family Issues / Abortion / Adoption	*TRD*	Trade (Domestic & Foreign)
FIR	Firearms / Guns / Ammunition	*TRA*	Transportation
FIN	Financial Institutions / Investments / Securities	*TOU*	Travel / Tourism
FOO	Food Industry (Safety, Labeling, etc.)	*TRU*	Trucking / Shipping
FOR	Foreign Relations	*URB*	Urban Development / Municipalities
FUE	Fuel / Gas / Oil	*UNM*	Unemployment
GAM	Gaming / Gambling / Casino	*UTI*	Utilities
GOV	Government Issues	*VET*	Veterans
HCR	Health Issues	*WAS*	Waste (hazardous / solid / interstate / nuclear)
		WEL	Welfare

Government Entity IDs

The `government_entity_id` field contains an integer array corresponding to government entities disclosed in the given issue section of the filing. There are 254 distinct government entity IDs. In this file, we list the top 20 most common government entity IDs. Within the data download package you can find a file `government_entity_mapping.csv` which contains three columns: `government_entity_id`, `government_entity_name`, and `count_entities` (a measure of the frequency of this entity in our dataset).

Entity ID	Full Entity Name
1	U.S. Senate
2	U.S. House of Representatives
11	Executive Office of the President (EOP)
12	White House Office
18	Office of Management & Budget (OMB)
22	U.S. Trade Representative (USTR)
23	Department of Agriculture (USDA)
24	Department of Commerce (DOC)
25	Department of Defense (DOD)
33	Department of Energy
34	Department of Health & Human Services (HHS)
36	Department of Interior (DOI)
37	Department of Justice (DOJ)
38	Department of Labor (DOL)
39	Department of State (DOS)
40	Department of Transportation (DOT)
41	Department of Treasury
49	Environmental Protection Agencies (EPA)
136	Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS)
201	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)

Dealing with Array Data

In this section we describe a basic workflow to unpack ARRAY-encoded data into individual rows using the **R** programming language and the popular **tidyverse** family of software packages. We provide this example code strictly for user convenience, and do not offer support for data cleaning or manipulation tasks.

```
library(tidyverse)

# Read the data
long_data <- read_csv("issues.csv") |>
  # Remove the braces that are at the beginning and end of the ARRAY
  mutate(government_entity_ids = str_replace_all(government_entity_ids, "[{}]", "")) |>
  # Split the array by comma
  separate_longer_delim(government_entity_ids, delim=",") |>
  # Convert the resulting field to a numeric type
  type_convert()
```

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Data and Version Notes

This data was generated on 2024-10-25. For detailed version history, please see the `version.pdf` file. This dataset is considered stable, meaning that future updates should not generally affect existing data. Updates add new report-issue pairs as we gather them.

Reporting Data Issues

Our team has invested an enormous amount of effort to ensure that the LobbyView data is of the highest possible quality. If you detect an error in our data, we would love to hear from you. Please contact lobbydata@gmail.com and include as much information as possible so we can understand the error you are reporting.

Connecting LobbyView Data

The below diagram provides a quick guide explaining how to connect each LobbyView data download to each other, and to external datasets.

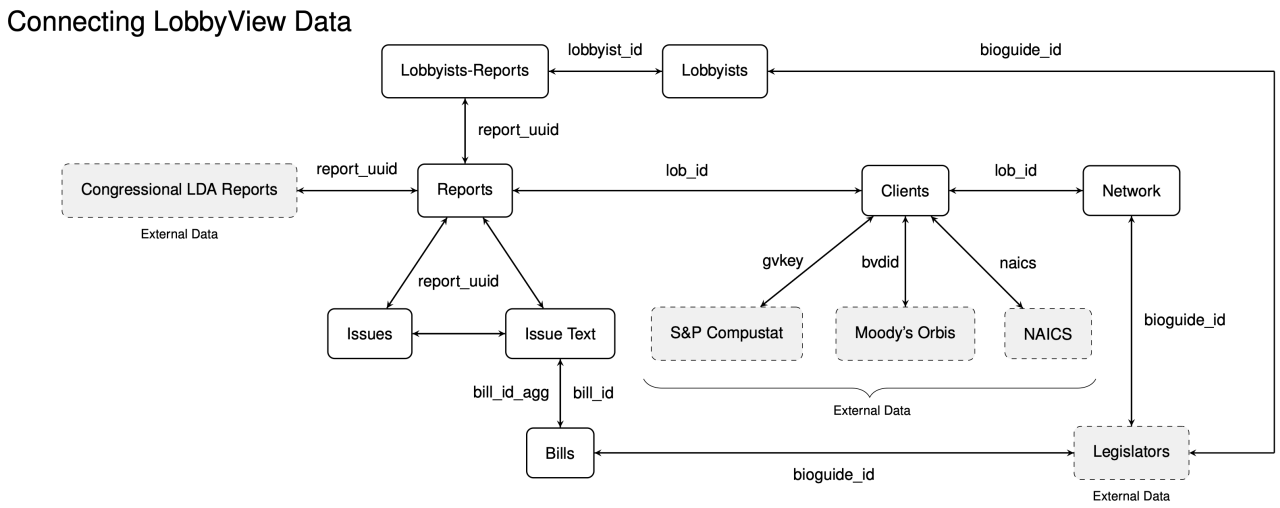


Figure 1: Connection Diagram